

Comparative Analysis of Barcelona and Inter Milan Offensive Strengths Champions League (2024–2025) aucrecy

1. Objective

The objective of this report is to compare the attacking performance of Barcelona and Inter Milan in the Champions League 24-25 based on data visualized in Tableau, focusing on creativity, passing efficiency, possession contribution, and finishing effectiveness.

This project consists of 8 sheets, 2 dashboards, and 1 story.

2. Data, Pre-processing, and Assumptions

2.1 Data Source

The detailed player and team statistics for FC Barcelona's 2024–2025 UEFA Champions League were found on [1].

The detailed player and team statistics for Inter Milan 2024–2025 UEFA Champions were found on [2]. Taking into account that it was not possible to download the CSV data from this source. Therefore, I used AI tools to convert the tables into CSV files.

2.2 Pre-processing

Metrics were standardized and player performance was made fairly comparable by calculating the 'per 90 minutes' (per 90s) metrics for all key offensive and creative measures.

2.3 Assumptions

The data were used in this project based on the assumptions that would guarantee that the output would serve the tactical goal of the project.

This project focuses on evaluating the attacking efficiency of both teams. Therefore, a position filter was applied to all the data sets to exclude the defenders and the goalkeepers and include only players with offensive and constructive roles.

Moreover, all players who have played fewer than 4 matches were excluded to ensure fairness in the ranking, so the final analysis would be meaningful.

3. Analytical Structure and Sheets Explanation

In this project, there are 4 main analysis we are focusing on as follows:

- 1- SCA (Shot-Creating Actions) per 90 minutes: To identify the average shots of each player.
- 2- Total touch: To evaluate a player's involvement in play and build-up attacks.
- 3- Passing Accuracy by Pass Length: To evaluate the player's performance in passing based on the distance.
- 4- Player Attacking Contribution (per 90): To evaluate the efficiency of finishing attacks.

4. Dashboard Interpretation and Tactical Analysis

4.1 Barcelona Dashboard

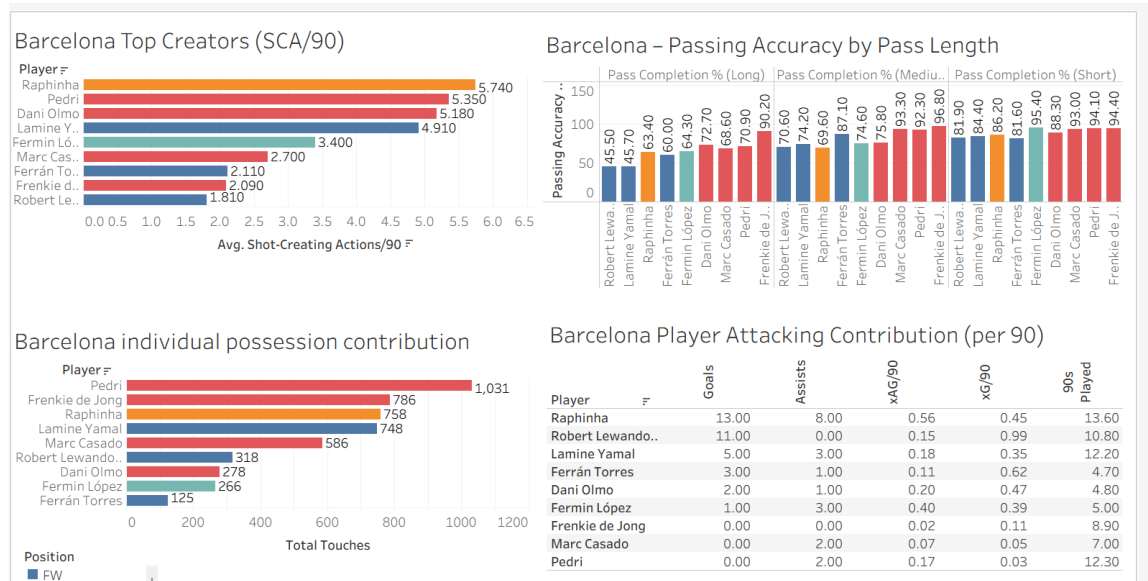


Figure 1: Barcelona Dashboard

This dashboard highlights Barcelona’s offensive efficiency through creativity, passing accuracy, and goal contribution.

Pedri shows a consistently high contribution across all actions leading to shots on goal (Shot-Creating Actions) and also records the most touches in the team. His strong performance in both metrics highlights his central role and importance in Barcelona’s midfield buildup and creativity. Raphinha and Dani Olmo also drive most of the team’s chance creation.

Frenkie de Jong has an astonishing passing accuracy, with over 90% passing accuracy across short, medium, and long distances. It is rare to have such an accuracy rate in all pass types, which makes him the main connection between the defenders and the attackers.

Raphinha and Lewandowski are the top goal scorers with 24 goals scored out of a total of 40 goals, which is equal to 60% of the team's total goals.

4.2 Inter Milan Dashboard

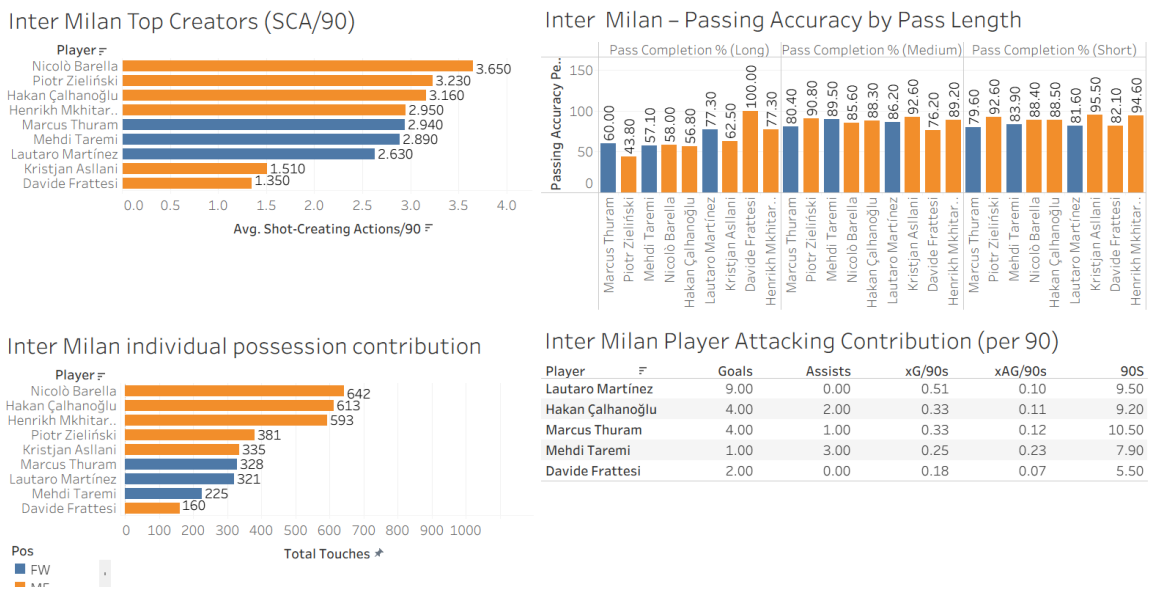


Figure 2: Inter Milan Dashboard

This dashboard highlights Inter Milan's offensive efficiency through creativity, passing accuracy, and goal contribution.

Nicolò Barella and Federico Dimarco show a consistently high contribution across all actions leading to shots on goal (Shot-Creating Actions) and also record the most touches in the team. Their strong performance in both metrics highlights their central role and importance in Inter Milan's midfield buildup and creativity.

Davide Frattesi has a 100% accuracy rate for long passes, which is rare since long passes are the hardest type to execute. This makes him an important player for building attacks, especially counterattacks.

Lautaro Martínez is the most effective striker who scored 9 goals out of team total goals 20 which equals to %45, leading in both Goals and xG/90, confirming his finishing efficiency.

5. Insights & Comparison

- Barcelona shows more creativity and buildup through midfield (Pedri & De Jong), emphasizing possession and short passes.
- Inter Milan relies more on direct progression and wing play, using Dimarco and Barella to advance the ball quickly.
- Both teams are efficient in their own styles, but Barcelona dominates in possession metrics, while Inter Milan excels in conversion and efficiency.

6. Conclusion & Recommendations

In conclusion, Barcelona's midfield control gives them a higher chance to dominate possession and create more opportunities, while Inter Milan's faster and more vertical playstyle ensures high attacking efficiency. Coaches should leverage these strengths Barcelona focusing on midfield combinations, and Inter Milan on fast transitions and exploiting wing play.

References

- [1] Aliratel01, "FC Barcelona Champions League 24/25 Stats," 2024. [Online]. Available: <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/aliratel01/fc-barcelona-champions-league-2425-stats>.
- [2] FBref, "2024–2025 Inter Milan Stats, Champions League," Sports Reference LLC, 2024. [Online]. Available: <https://fbref.com/en/squads/d609edc0/2024-2025/c8/Internazionale-Stats-Champions-League>. [Accessed 5 October 2025].